



Delaware County Commissioners Meeting October 4th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SnKHwaw3-gl
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Date & Time: Monday, October 4, 2021 | 9:02 a.m.

Body: Delaware County Commissioners

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript indicates that the regular meeting was called directly to order, featuring an immediate public hearing as the first item of business.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order on Monday, October 4, 2021, at 9:02 a.m., followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Henry, Ms. Reagan, Mr. King, and Mr. Rat (Roll call recorded by Steve, Clerk/Auditor).
 - **Absent:** None noted.

- **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly designated by name in the transcript opening, though Mr. Henry and Mr. King actively led portions of the agenda.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** 00:34:00 The minutes of the September 20, 2021 commissioners meeting were submitted for approval.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:00:49 Public Hearing: Regulating Traffic on Certain Public Streets in Delaware County (Ordinance 2021-027)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Highway Department / Commissioners.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive debate regarding proposed speed regulations, stop sign installations, and traffic safety on County Road 560 East (near Prairie Creek Park/Reservoir). Proponents emphasized extreme speeding (up to 70 mph in a 30 mph zone) and safety risks for children, cyclists, and park visitors. Opponents and community members argued that stop signs used strictly for speed control ("nuisance stop signs") violate traffic standards, increase pollution/fuel consumption, and create greater safety hazards between stops. Law enforcement and highway officials discussed potential alternative solutions, including multi-use bike paths, solar speed-monitoring signs, and adjusted speed limits.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - 00:01:11 **Linda Michael** (Resident/Business Owner): Spoke in favor of stricter enforcement and safety controls due to chronic speeding (50-70 mph) endangering park visitors, employees, and property.
 - 00:04:10 **Bob Taylor** (Resident): Supported safety measures and suggested installing solar-powered speed/license plate recording devices instead of relying solely on police manpower.
 - 00:06:19 **Ashley Wright** (City of Muncie / Prairie Creek Park): Supported safety concepts but raised liability concerns regarding stop signs placed at the beach entrance on city property.
 - 00:07:37 **Dustin Clark** (Superintendent, Perry Creek): Supported overall safety improvements and future trail connection concepts.
 - 00:09:49 **Cheryl Indus** (Resident): Opposed the proposed stop signs as an ineffective "nuisance" measure, noting they would not address entry-point speeds

- and could cause driver frustration; requested data and targeted patrols instead.
- **00:13:47 Tony Skinner** (Delaware County Sheriff): Noted that the 30 mph speed limit is unrealistically low for the area compared to surrounding townships (which are 40-55 mph), contributing to speeding. Proposed a 1.2-mile dedicated multi-use path for pedestrians, golf carts, and bicycles to remove them from the roadway.
 - **00:16:18 Tommy Humber** (County Highway Department): Supported immediate safety actions, noting a traffic study showed an 85th percentile speed of 47.8 mph, and argued that highway crews face extreme danger working on the road without traffic calming.
 - **00:19:56 Kristen Hirst** (Resident): Opposed stop signs, citing traffic engineering studies indicating they increase speeds between intersections ("nuisance stop signs") and add vehicle emissions.
 - **00:29:22 Janet Bertram** (Resident): Opposed the stop signs, stating she crosses the road frequently without issue and that parking lot behavior is a greater hazard than road traffic.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** **00:32:26** Motion to close the public hearing passed unanimously by roll call vote. Later in the meeting (**00:44:06**), Ordinance 2021-027 was brought forward for second reading and **amended** to reduce the installation from three stop signs down to a single stop sign at County Road 450 South (plus electronic speed signs), with the original three-sign plan held for reevaluation.
 - **Amended Ordinance Vote:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
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00:32:39 Appointment: Delaware County Redevelopment Commission

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration of Mr. John Adams (Delcoms School Board member) for a non-voting appointment representing school boards/superintendents.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
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00:33:18 Appointment: Airport Authority Board

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a Republican board seat requiring political balance. Commissioners noted they are awaiting formal written resignation from the current member before making a new appointment.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table **passed** by Roll Call Vote (Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
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00:35:08 Presentation / Community Recognition: Country Village Neighborhood

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mitch Isaacs, President of Country Village Creekwood Neighborhood Association.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Isaacs presented a token of appreciation (vegan branded cookies from local bakery Sea Salt and Cinnamon) to the commissioners and highway department. He thanked the board for initiating a multi-year concrete road reconstruction and patching plan that has significantly improved neighborhood infrastructure after decades of neglect.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote required.
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00:36:39 Contract / Agreement: 2022 Holiday Schedule

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of the proposed county holiday schedule for 2022, which includes the addition of Juneteenth as a paid holiday. Discussion occurred regarding whether Christmas Eve (falling on a Friday) should be a half-day or full-day closure.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved as presented (full-day closures retained) by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Ms. Reagan: No, Mr. King: Yes).
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00:39:14 LPA Consulting Contract: RQAW (Bridge 112)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Moyer (County Highway/Engineering).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Standard INDOT boilerplate contract for engineering/replacement services for Bridge 112, located on 600 South at Williams Creek. The contract is not to exceed \$224,000, backed by 80% federal/state reimbursement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
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00:40:09 Construction Inspection Service Contract: Bridge 125

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Moyer (County Highway/Engineering).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Standard INDOT boilerplate contract for construction inspection services for Bridge 125 on Nebo Road over York Prairie Creek (slated for construction next year). Total contract not to exceed \$214,000, with 80% reimbursement. Board and staff discussed coordination with upcoming roundabout construction to minimize neighborhood cut-through traffic impacts.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
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00:42:15 Humana Group Medicare Advantage Plan Renewal

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Pam McCammon, Human Resource Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual renewal for the retiree over-65 Humana Medicare Advantage plan option. Carved out at no direct cost to the county while providing lower medical costs for participating retirees.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
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00:42:57 Ordinance 2021-028 (First Reading): Traffic Regulation on Nebo Road at CR 350 North

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Highway / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction of an ordinance to establish an all-way stop intersection at Nebo Road and County Road 350 North due to high-speed traffic, accident history, and sight-obstruction issues.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced and advanced for public hearing by Roll Call Vote (Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

General public comments were largely integrated into the preceding statutory public hearing for Ordinance 2021-027 (detailed under Section 4).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **00:49:07 Pam McCammon (HR):** Announced upcoming employee flu shot clinics scheduled for October 20th (County Building and Justice Center) and October 27th (Highway Department) for full-time employees on county health insurance.
 - **00:49:54 Commissioner Discussions:** Commissioners reviewed jail population figures (housing 20<U+2013>25 out-of-county inmates at \$40/day), correctional officer staffing/vacancies, and requested financial breakdowns from the auditor regarding out-of-county inmate revenues and salary cost savings.
 - **00:43:10 Iron Man Event:** Commissioners praised the Muncie Mayor, Sheriff<U+2019>s Department, EMA, EMS, and highway/park staff for their successful support and traffic management during the recent Iron Man athletic event.
 - **00:49:54 Memorial Acknowledgment:** **00:45:54** Commissioner Henry requested a moment of silence in remembrance of Brent Langdon, a fairgrounds employee who

passed away unexpectedly.

- **Adjournment:** 1:05:45 Official motion to recess/adjourn passed by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).

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